SYED ZARAK HASSAN

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Professional Summary

Technical Builder and Operations specialist bridging software engineering, cyber security, and business growth. Completed a placement at Thrive Learning where I built production ready tools to automate operational bottlenecks. I focus on making manual friction obsolete through automation, having built internal systems that reduced contract approval cycles by 70%. Previously co led a startup design agency for 3 years, managing 15+ client accounts and scaling revenue. I position myself as a force multiplier for founders, using technical rigor (BSc Software Engineering, MSc Cyber Security) to build the systems that enable business speed.

Technical Skills and Core Competencies

Ops & Strategy: Founder Associate workflows, Revenue Operations (RevOps), Project Management, Client Strategy, CRM Architecture, GTM Automation Workflows.
Technical Builder: TypeScript, Next.js 15, Supabase (PostgreSQL), Claude API, Claude Code, Cursor (Cursor SDK Development), Devin, Codex, Lovable, Replit, n8n, Automation Workflows, Agentic Frameworks (Claude-Harness).
Compliance & Risk: ISO 27001, ISO 9001, SOC 2, GDPR, Third Party Risk Management, Vendor Risk Intelligence, RFI/RFQ Ownership, Audit Readiness.
Platforms: Vanta, Cakewalk, Jira, Pulseway, Kandji, Render, Vercel, Tailwind CSS.

Professional Experience

GRC Analyst - Thrive Learning, Nottingham, UK
September 2025 - September 2026 (1 Year Internship)

Key Achievements:

- Guided the business through a successful ISO 9001 Stage 1 audit by designing 6 end-to-end process flows for non-technical teams.
- Delivered a high-value prospect RFI by mapping security controls to client requirements, contributing directly to deal closure.
- Cut contract and DPA approval time by 70% by redesigning the company-wide DPA tracking process and building ContraAI, an internal AI-powered contract review platform, for procurement and legal teams.
- Led MDM migration to Kandji/Iru across 250+ endpoints with zero downtime, reducing IT support tickets by 40%.
- Identified the Shai-Hulud NPM supply chain threat and engineered a custom scan + remediation script deployed via Iru to secure the developer fleet immediately.

Co Founder and Commercial Lead - Nexique Design Labs, Pakistan
September 2021 - August 2024

- Owned the entire GTM and delivery pipeline for 3 years, securing $8,500+ in revenue across 15+ accounts by leading all cold outreach, phone calling, and organic lead generation from first contact to project sign off.
- Achieved a 98% satisfaction rate and maintained a 7% churn rate across 3 years by managing the full account lifecycle, ensuring recurring business that consistently outweighed customer loss.
- Built a custom Notion based CRM and project management system from scratch to track revenue, leads, and delivery timelines, replacing fragmented manual spreadsheets.
- Developed organic marketing strategies and video content that gained 50k+ views, driving significant new business without a paid marketing budget.
- Mentored a team of 5 interns, creating structured tutorials and automated workflows to get them productive quickly without pulling senior time away from delivery.

Founder's Associate - Latoon Music, Peshawar, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Pakistan (On-site)
January 2020 - February 2021

Key Achievements:

- Coordinated 5 concurrent client projects from initial discussions through delivery, aligning commercial proposals, procurement, requirements, timelines, and follow ups across leadership and project teams.
- Led client and stakeholder communication during onsite events, presenting the organisation's services, answering commercial questions, and helping convert conversations into qualified opportunities.
- Prepared and refined proposals, project documentation, and client facing materials across 5 active projects, improving the clarity and professionalism of client submissions.
- Connected senior leadership, project teams, clients, and external partners, closing information gaps and reducing the time required to move decisions forward by approximately 40%.

Projects & Tools

VenderScope - Continuous Vendor Risk Intelligence Platform
github.com/syed-hassan7/venderscope | venderscope.vercel.app

- Built out of frustration managing 50+ vendor audits manually in Vanta at Thrive Learning. Monitors vendor estates 24/7 across HIBP, NVD/NIST, Shodan, and Companies House, replacing annual reviews with a live weighted risk score (0–100).
- Used in real audit workflows alongside Vanta to surface breach history, active CVEs, exposed infrastructure, and compliance evidence across ISO 27001, SOC 2, GDPR, and Cyber Essentials.
- Generates one-click PDF audit reports structured for ISO 27001 Annex A and Cyber Essentials reviews, with a risk score drift timeline showing how a vendor's posture changes over time.

Maternify - Multilingual Safety Gated AI Maternal Advocacy Platform **(VibeHack London Hackathon Team Project)**
github.com/syed-hassan7/maternify | maternify-theta.vercel.app/

- Engineered and shipped a production-ready MVP in just 24 hours for VibeHack London 2026, securing **5th place out of the Health Impact track**.
- Co-built a hardcoded safety gate that bypasses AI generation for clinical red-flags, routing users directly to 999/triage cards, ensuring zero "AI reassurance" for medical emergencies.
- Multimodal Tech Stack: Developed using Next.js 14, GLM-5.1, and Gemini (multimodal STT/OCR, embeddings for RAG, and TTS for midwife-script playback).
- Co-engineered an in-memory RAG system over curated NHS and Tommy's documentation, ensuring every advocacy script is clinically evidenced and cited.
- Aided in addressing maternal mortality disparities (MBRRACE-UK) by giving minority-ethnic women an advocacy "voice" via clinically-grounded scripts, rather than just simple translation. Backed by research (internal research paper).

Education

Master of Science in Cyber Security

Nottingham Trent University, UK | January 2025 - December 2026 (Expected)

- **Dissertation**: Investigated whether diagrammatic techniques improve auditor comprehension of complex systems, combining case studies and interviews to demonstrate measurable improvements in understanding at small scale.
- **Relevant modules**: Network Security, Digital Forensics, Secure Software Development and Ethical Hacking.

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering

Iqra National University, Pakistan | February 2020 - February 2024

- Graduated with **Distinction**.

Certifications

Google Professional Cyber Security Certificate (2024) / Coursera and Google

Introduction to Python (2023) / Sololearn

Introduction to SQL (2023) / Sololearn